

Tolga Çakan

Industrial Engineer · Process Improvement & Digital Products

PORTFOLIO tolgacakan.vercel.app

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PROFILE

Industrial engineer (Istanbul Bilgi University, 2026) who turns loosely defined problems into working products and leaner processes. Co-founder of TAB Marketing, where I take NFC, QR and web products from customer discovery through supplier production to rollout for 15+ hospitality businesses. Before that: product work at BTCTurk, Kaizen on a Toyota assembly line, and an award-winning senior design project that more than doubled a textile line's efficiency. Now looking to bring this to a product or operations team.

EXPERIENCE

2026-present	Co-founder, Product & Operations, TAB Marketing 3-person startup · Istanbul & Sakarya - Launched seven NFC, QR and web product lines, now in use at 15+ cafés, restaurants and hotels. - Turned owner interviews and competitor research into requirements, then took each product through design, supplier production and on-site setup. - Built client websites, including francoserdivan.com, a live menu the café edits itself in Google Sheets.
Mar-Jul 2025	Intern, De Marke Agency Ran on-site organisation at international tournaments and worked on the agency's digital marketing.
Jan-Feb 2025	Product Intern, BTCTurk Technology - Benchmarked competing exchanges' features and user flows to inform product decisions. - Ran market research and user testing; shared findings via internal dashboards and structured reports.
Jun-Jul 2024	Engineering Intern, Toyota Motor Manufacturing Turkey Sakarya - Applied Kaizen, 5S and root cause analysis to assembly-line logistics; wrote standard work instructions. - Designed a process improvement project and presented it to Toyota's senior management.

PROJECTS

innerclock.vercel.app	Krone, web game React · TypeScript Mini-games, multiplayer rooms, daily challenges and leaderboards.
prototype	FeedDetox Next.js Reads what a social feed has learned about a user and generates content packs to steer it elsewhere.

SKILLS

Product	Customer discovery · competitive benchmarking · market research · user testing · requirements and scoping · roadmapping · dashboards and reporting
Operations	Lean (Kaizen, 5S) · root cause analysis · standard work · ergonomics · waste reduction · supplier and production coordination · event operations and budgeting
Data & tools	Excel (VBA) · SQL · Python · JavaScript · TypeScript · React · Next.js · Git · Figma
AI	LLM-assisted workflows · prompt design and iteration
Domain	Crypto exchanges and DeFi (published research) · NFC and QR systems in hospitality
Languages	Turkish (native) · English (professional working proficiency)

EDUCATION

- Istanbul Bilgi University, BSc Industrial Engineering. Graduated June 2026
- Fen Lisesi, Sakarya, Turkey

AWARDS, PROGRAMMES & CERTIFICATES

- Best Senior Design Project Award**, Industrial Engineering, Istanbul Bilgi University (2026), for "Improvement of Precision, Quality and Worker Well-Being in Sock Manufacturing: Case of ÖRS Textile". Ergonomic and process redesign on a live production line that cut material waste and scrap and more than doubled line efficiency. Top five of its term; presented at CSRP 2026
- AI Engineering Internship**, FlyRank AI (2026). Remote and project-based: five reviewed assignments and a capstone
- AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations**, Anthropic Education (Jul 2026) · [verify](#)
- Claude 101**, Anthropic Education (Jul 2026) · [verify](#)

PUBLICATION

- Chapter XI, "Blockchain ve Eğlence Sektörü", in *Blockchain Teknolojileri ve Sektörel Etkileri*. Nobel Bilimsel Eserler, 2022, as independent researcher. ISBN 978-625-433-825-0

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

- Vice President & Operations Lead**, Atatürkçü Düşünce Kulübü, Bilgi University (2021-2024). Led planning and delivery of 10+ large-scale forums and conferences for students across Istanbul, the largest a live panel of 4,000+ attendees. Owned speakers, sponsors, budgets, venues and on-site teams
- Editorial Director**, Bilgi Blockchain Club (2021-2024). Commissioned and edited the club's publications and forum programme
- He For She**, Erasmus+ Youth Exchange, Saaremaa, Estonia (December 2023). Youthpass certified
- European Summer School**, Blockchain to Financial Markets. Prague, 2025
- Drums & songwriting**, *son sek'*. One album, two singles, live shows ([Spotify](#))